

WORKSHOP: **PROTECT** YOUR PRIVACY ONLINE

The NSA just showed us how limited our online privacy truly is. Here is a small workshop that just might be able to restore some measure of privacy to your current, pseudo-private online life.

Anirudh Regidi

Before we begin, we need a disclaimer of sorts. None of the methods we're listing out here are guaranteed to offer privacy. As we don't have any spies inside the NSA (or any other security agency for that matter) and have no access to any concrete evidence to support the claimed features of the services we will list, we don't know for sure if the methods actually work. What we can say is that steps and services that we'll list in the following article will, in theory, provide

a far more secure and private online life than you previously experienced.

The big question is not how you protect your privacy, but rather, why? What do you hope to achieve? Complete Internet anonymity? Do you just want to hide a bit of, ahem, indiscreet browsing? Are you an activist hell-bent on joining the ranks of Anonymous and the like? The latter is something that we can't help you with, but the rest, well, let's see.

First, here are a list of general guidelines that you need to follow while online.

There won't be much point in worrying about whether Google is reading your Gmail if your accounts are open already compromised is there?

- **Passwords:** Probably the most important component of your online life, the password is much neglected by most. No matter how many times we're told that we need multiple, strong, secure passwords, we don't keep them. Maybe we're lazy or maybe we're just short on memory, who knows? The point is, people who tell you to change